

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION

Hey, I'm Sandra.

I'm a divorced mom of three, born and raised in Iceland and now living in Norway. And for a long time, I felt lost, overwhelmed, impulsive and confused not just in my content, but in my own life. I kept waiting for someone else to tell me what to do, hand me the success, because I couldn't see my own strength yet. I didn't have trust in myself.

Then everything changed.

My 14-year relationship ended. My heart got broken and My world collapsed. I went from "we" to just me—in a two-bedroom apartment with my 3 kids, and a dog, terrified out of my mind. No money, no plan. But in that rock bottom moment, I realized something hard and beautiful:

it was finally time to choose me. Time to change and take back control over my life.

I started to post on social media again after years of trying to grow there but never succeeded. I started to post selfie tutorials. And in just 2 months, I had grown my social media to over 100K followers built a brand from taking selfies in my bathroom. Scared overwhelmed. Finally feel seen, accepted and ready to build my empire with all the amazing women who cheered me on when I was posting without confidence.

The Spark That Ignited My Mission

For years, I told myself the same lies:

- *I need someone to provide for me*
- *I'm too old to start over*
- *I'm too impulsive and messy to be taken seriously*

Those thoughts? They were killing my potential in silence.

Leaving my marriage wasn't just walking away from a relationship—it was walking away from those beliefs. From people, places and things that were feeding me negative energy. And as painful as it was, that breakdown gave me a new foundation to rebuild everything.

*So, I decided This is my time, I'm ready now. I started with what I had.
With me. Messy, scared and imperfect*

What This StoryBank Is

This isn't just a list of cute stories or moments I've lived through.

This is the truth behind the woman you see now. The rise from rock bottom. The mindset shifts, the tears, the glow-ups. It's how I became her—"Sandra Selfie and Social" building a brand, life, and business from scratch. SSA SOCIAL

Every story here is a piece of the blueprint. Not just for me, but for the next woman coming up behind me.

Why Selfies Matter

*We all need photos to use for our brand, to use in our website, emails, content on social media and Let's be real, no one is going to capture YOU, your style and your aesthetic as authentic as your self. Well, maybe if you hire an AMAZING but super expensive brand photographer. But in the beginning you maybe dont have the budget to hire someone to take your brand photos, but you need to have photos that look professional, looks and feels like you, and creates an overall consistent look everywhere online. It's about **visibility**. It's about representing your business as "I am confident and proffesional" It's about being proud of your brand without the massive budget and about showing the authentic and powerful YOU Owning your image is powerful. Owning your story? That's unstoppable.*

Turning Pain Into Power

The betrayal. The heartbreak. The fear of starting from zero?

They built power I didn't know I had:

Courage. Authenticity. Strength

From Scarcity to Abundance

I used to think money only came if someone gave it to me. From a man who is the sole provider. I am raised with a money mindset that women struggle if they dont have a man to support them. I have worked hard to rewire my mind to an abundance mindset, that we can create our own wealth. You don't need someone else to do it for you

Now I teach women how to create income with nothing but a phone, a story, and the decision to show up.

ADHD & Owning My Chaos

I've heard it all:

"You're too impulsive."

"You're so all over the place."

"You're doing too much."

"Your doing to little"

"Your Lazy"

"You work way to much"

"You have to be realistic"

Now I know—that's my power

I move fast. I act before I feel ready.

And that's exactly why I grow, evolve, and lead.

The Selfie to CEO™ Movement

You don't need fancy equipment.

You don't need a huge following.

You don't need anyone's permission.

You need your story.

Your phone.

And the guts to post your truth—unfiltered.

This is about reclaiming who you are.

It's about saying, "I'm enough."

Not in spite of your scars—but because of them.

SECTION 2: THE SHATTERED ILLUSION

2.1 Living in Denial

I knew something was off. Maybe for months. Maybe for years.

I told myself, *"It's not that bad." I love him, I will never find someone else, what if I regret my decision and want him back and then he has already moved on with someone else.*

It kept me stuck in the same story, same routine and in the same unhappy life

I told myself:

- "I can't leave—what about the kids?"
- "I need him to survive."
- "Maybe it'll get better."

But deep down, I knew.

It took one moment of betrayal to rip the blindfold off.

There was no going back.

I couldn't unsee it.

I couldn't pretend anymore.

And it wasn't just about losing him.

It was about losing the version of me that felt safe keeping me in my comfort zone

2.2 Moving Into a Two-Bedroom Apartment

Packing up my life felt like a death.

Every photo, every mug, every drawing my kids taped to the fridge—it all screamed, *"This used to be your life."*

And with every box I carried out of the door, I asked myself:

Am I really doing this?

The first few weeks were brutal.

New apartment. Tiny and not enough bedrooms for everyone.

The kids got the bedrooms (my boys sharing one room)

I slept on the couch, empty fridge and an even emptier bank account.

Fear was everywhere.

The Lack was everywhere, self-doubt and guilt were overwhelming

2.3 The Loneliness & the Letdown

As an Icelander living in Norway, I felt completely disconnected.

I missed my family. My childhood friends.

Even simple things—setting up internet, paying bills—felt like unbearable when I was an emotional wreck.

Afraid that I was letting my kids down, Trying to put on a brave face and not let them see me cry or be sad. How am I going to get through this? I probably need to get 2-3 jobs and then I will never see my kids. I will be more miserable and more alone. Am I doing the right thing? Am I being selfish? Why am I always getting in the same situations over and over?

2.4 The Inner Conflict: Fight or Flight

I thought about going back.
Of course I did.

Back to what I knew.
Back to the house, the routine, the safety.

But deep down, I knew the truth:

Things were never going to change, or get better.
I had nothing left to give but myself.

So, I kept going.

Every day became a test:
Do I post this video?
Do I keep building my business?
Do I keep walking forward—even when I'm scared?

And the answer was always: **Yes.**

SECTION 3: THE REBUILD

Starting over was terrifying. But there was also a strange kind of freedom in it. I suddenly had time for myself again, The kids were with their dad every other week and at first it was lonely and quiet. But I had time to see things in a new way, with clarity and focus. Having that one week every other week by myself. I suddenly had the time to work on myself, on my business and create content I loved without the pressure of I have to hurry

before the kids come home, I need to rush because when they wake up I can't focus because the kids will start arguing, or I need to make dinner first.

For the first time in years I had time for myself, time to think, time to gather my thoughts and overwhelm.

In the quiet of my tiny apartment, in between the fear and the breakdowns, something changed.

A thought I couldn't ignore:

What if everything I lost... was just making space for everything I was meant to become?

3.1 The Bathroom Studio

From Luxury to DIY

The big house? Gone.

The "safe" income from someone else? Gone.

So I got scrappy.

I turned my bathroom into a studio.

A cheap tripod from SHEIN. My phone. Whatever lighting I could find.

It wasn't fancy, but it was mine. My house had these gorgeous big windows that made my content look so aesthetic and beautiful, I didn't need any extra light sources. Now I was living in an apartment that had little natural light (well, not as much as my old house did) I tried to film in every corner and every room of my apartment, but it never was in the quality as I wanted it to be. I didn't let that stop me, though.. I got Scrapy and bought some cheap softboxes and a ringlight and made a filming studio in my bathroom.

Early Experiments

The first reel I filmed? The lighting was off. It wasn't as good as before
But I kept going.

I took a step away from waiting for it to be perfect.

I was creating something from nothing—and that made me feel powerful.

I realized: **creativity beats resources, every time.**

3.2 Embracing the Selfie (and the Stage Fright)

The Birth of the "Selfie Queen"

I played with angles, lighting, poses. Different editing styles, voiceovers vs face to camera, A day in my life vs beauty content? I failed. A lot.

But every “bad” photo and video taught me something.

And eventually, I started to create with passion again. Not by ugh.. I need to post something today.

People started watching. Women started responding.

Not because I was perfect—but because I was *real*.

Of course people judged.

Old friends. Neighbors. Even family:

“What is she doing now?”, “*Who does she think she is?*” “*Is she really trying to be an influencer?*”

But with every post... every kind message... every woman who said, “*Thank you for showing up,*”

The fear faded, the selfdoubt got quieter,

And my voice got louder.

3.3 Financial Fears & First Small Wins

Budgeting for a Dream

Every cent counted.

I was choosing between feeding my kids out or investing in a \$200 course.

But that pressure made my priorities crystal clear:

Build the brand. Take care of the kids. Don’t waste a cent.

First Online Income

The first time I made money from my phone?

It hit like fireworks.

I wasn’t just surviving anymore.

I was building something.

The Seed of a Bigger Vision

That small win became a stepping stone.

Then another. Then another.

I started mapping ideas. Captions. Freebies. Tutorials.

I didn’t even know what a “funnel” was—but I was already in the game.

3.4 Overcoming Self-Doubt (Every Day)

ADHD & Imposter Syndrome

My brain? Constant chaos.

One minute I'm planning content. The next I'm reorganizing my kitchen.

Self-doubt constantly whispered, "*You'll never finish anything.*"

But I used my impulsive energy to my advantage.

If I had a spark of an idea—I acted *immediately*.

Record it. Post it. Launch it. Before fear had time to catch up.

Journals, Skincare & Mindset Work

My mornings became sacred.

Walks. Skincare. Podcasts. Audible on repeat.

Little routines reminded me: *You're not the old version of you anymore.*

Every day was another chance to choose the woman I was becoming.

My new rule?

"Better to post it imperfect than never at all."

I stopped chasing perfect.

I started showing up.

And that changed everything.